STEFANKATTERGOLFSCAPEEDIT

Travel Radio Australia, we're here at the International Golf Travel Market in Carnes in France and I have Stefan Carter from Golfscape UK and Stefan has a fantastic system where hotels and golf courses all around the world and travel-related people can hook into their software. Stefan, welcome to the program. Thanks Geoff, I appreciate you having me today.

Tell us a bit about Golfscape, first of all a bit about your background, how did you get involved in this area in the first place? Yeah, of course, I've been in golf for borderline 12 years now. I started out at a company called Jorgolf Travel in London, selling golf holidays within the UK market, dabbled a bit with the European market as well, that was my background. And then during Covid, I had maybe an early midlife crisis and realised I wanted to try something new.

To get into the tech side, I've always been really passionate about technology as a whole. I thought I'd combine my interests with golf, so I joined Golfscape in 2021. Great, and Golfscape, you were telling me before, is a really great interface service for all sorts of businesses.

Tell us a bit about how it works. Yeah, so we call ourselves the Expedia for Golf. We operate in 13 different countries worldwide.

Overall, we have 500 individual partners with us, so maybe groups as a whole that have like 10 properties or independent golf courses. So within our technology, we've got two sides. We have our tour approach side, so a customer can go to golfscape.com, they can book tee times or a hotel and golf in one button, effectively.

Everything's connected with the golf system or the hotel system. Everything's live, everything's instant. The customer books and pays and gets an instant confirmation email.

And then the second side is we have our technology. We call it White Label. We put it onto the golf course or the resource website themselves.

So as customers, they might know where they want to go. They might have always booked with that specific venue. And then they can use our technology to process that booking and process that payment.

Yeah, it's a wonderful system and it really is turnkey. It really makes the people running those businesses, gives them whole streamlines all their back end. Yeah, yeah, for sure.

I think like golf as a whole is still stuck in maybe the early 2000s. Everyone knows there needs to be a change, but no one really has gone into that change. The good thing about Golfscape is we're very technical minded.

So from the CEO down to our tech team, the vast majority aren't actually golfers. So they are really focused on the technical aspects. And then within the sales, the products and the

operations, we're all golfers.

So we've got a great boundary of knowing what to do on a golfer aspect. We also know what to do from a technical side as well. Now, tell us your impressions of this particular show, which is the International Golf Travel Market.

I suppose you as a representative of your company get so many contacts for Golfscape. Yeah, you know, I love our GTM. I've been coming for years now.

One, it's great to get out of the UK and come to somewhere maybe a bit warmer at this time of year. But two, it's getting to meet new and existing clients. Again, golf is very personable and doing stuff on Zoom or Teams or whatever it may be.

It's got to be done, but it's not the way to conduct business. And coming over here, just seeing people, you know, having a drink with them, playing golf with them and bouncing ideas off each other. That's why I like coming here.

Yeah, so what's your impression of Khan as a town? You've been here a few years now. I suppose you got to know it pretty well. Well, yeah, first of all, the beer is great.

Going to the sport as far as the evenings, but it's lovely, right? I hadn't been here until last year, staying at a hotel just around the corner, looking over at the marina, having my breakfast from a rooftop bar every morning. It's just fantastic. And I'm ashamed to go back tomorrow.

It's not just for golf businesses. Your system can go into other hotel and hospitality areas, right? Yeah, for sure. So I think predominantly we've always been a golf company, but we are exploring new opportunities.

So we have recently gone into sort of bigger hotel chains, Marriott, Sheraton's, Akhos and Hilton's as well. So, yes, we are a golf business, but we're not limited to golf. Excellent.

And how can people find out more about Golfscape online, Stefan? Yes, of course. So our website is just golfscape.com. Very simple. You can do one of two things.

You can either book your next holiday there or scroll to the bottom. It says a bit about us. You can send a form in.

Very easy. One of my team will pick up that form. We can have a call with you.

We can have an email with you and share more information about Golfscape. And finally, what's your couple of favorite destinations that you've come across in your course of your work? I suppose you get to visit so many places around the world. Oh, God, that's a great question.

I've never actually thought about it. I would have to say from being obviously from the UK, being

from London, I would say Arizona in the States, just because you've got Scottsdale Old Town, but then all of a sudden you're in the literal middle of the desert. From a tourist point of view, I think that's fantastic.

In terms of golf, my favorite golfing destination, probably Dubai, which might sound a bit cliche considering everyone goes there now, but it's millionaires' golf, right? You get the weather, you get the best golf courses. But then from a traditional aspect, I would have to probably say Scotland, which I've been playing up in Scotland most of my life. Played everywhere, apart from the old course, so that's on the bucket list.

So anyone out there listening, I would highly suggest getting over to Scotland. Great. Well, thank you so much, Stefan Cadda from Golfscape UK, and thank you very much for being on Travel Radio Australia.

Thanks, Geoff. Appreciate your time.